THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

NEWSLETTER - OCTOBER 2014

Chairman's Report

Since we last reported at the end of July we have seen the first of many ceremonies at which our Branch was represented. Appropriately the series commenced on 4th August with the Branch's traditional Ravivage de la Flamme at the Arc de Triomphe, especially poignant since it was 100 years to the day that Great Britain and her Empire declared war alongside our French allies who had declared 24 hours before.

There followed the ceremony on 30th August at Lyons-la-Forêt (Eure) where we were invited to attend the celebration of the Liberation of the town on that day by the British 7th Armoured Brigade. On 5th September we attended the commemoration at the Chateau de Vaux-le-Pénil where Maréchal Joffre and Field-Marshal French had planned the First Battle of the Marne – the first time our two countries had fought side-by-side since the Crimea exactly 60 years before. On 15th September we attended the Ravivage de la Flamme to commemorate the 74th Anniversary of the Battle of Britain. On 20th September we were invited by Branch member Didier Dumont, the Maire of Bennecourt (Yvelines), to attend the ceremony to commemorate the Liberation of Bennecourt in 1944 by the Coldstream Guards. Bennecourt is now twinned with the town of Coldstream. The Guards Band attended the ceremony and Church Service. 150 Guards arrived in front of the Mairie in the morning, having cycled from London to raise funds for their Regimental Benevolent Association. Didier's leadership qualities and talent for organization were clear for all to see when we entered the Médiathèque. Here his Commune of 1,800 inhabitants had, without outside funding, mounted an exhibition of personal documents, uniforms and memorabilia from the Great War. All these exhibits had been unearthed by the townspeople from their attics, trunks and drawers. A team of volunteers had worked often for 9 hours a day. Didier has prepared the Notice attached to this Newsletter and if a Branch member is in the vicinity they are encouraged to pay the exhibition a visit, as well as the other supporting events shown. Truly impressive. Bravo Didier. The last ceremony before we went to print was at the Commonwealth Cemetery at Montreuil-aux-Lyons (Aisne), where 171 graves are maintained. These casualties were in the Battle of the Aisne, in mid- to late September 1914. Grand-children of several of the fallen attended from England, Scotland, Northern Ireland and the USA, and as we often experience, the atmosphere at these intimate, local ceremonies is especially moving.

May I take this opportunity to remind members that subscriptions are due, as of 1st October, and we encourage you to maintain your membership which goes towards the financing the platform from which to mount our Charitable work. Mark Yates has prepared the Subscription renewal form attached.

In our traditional "For Your Diary" item overleaf you will find listed our next events. We draw your attention in particular to our Poppy Appeal Coffee Morning at the Ambassador's Residence, held at the kind invitation of Lady Ricketts. On this occasion the book compiled so diligently by Grahame Warby will be launched and will be on sale. The title is "Our say, Not Hearsay". Attached is the flyer prepared by the publisher, Mansion Field. The contents have been written by members and friends of our Branch and deal with their experience in uniform or out of it during the Second World War and in subsequent conflicts. Net profits will be donated to our Branch and we owe Grahame a huge Thank You for all his voluntary work, plus of course we thank the contributors for responding

so spontaneously to his request for stories.

Plans for the Commonwealth Service of Remembrance at Notre Dame de Paris are now in place, and we expect a particularly high turnout for this Centenary event.

We have an appeal to make to those who plan to attend future monthly Club Lunches that payment for these should be made to Joan Hicks in advance, and that any cancellations after a date to be defined will incur a penalty.

We have been aware for some time of the efforts we should be making to reach out to the English-speaking schools in Ile-de-France, and we are pleased to announce that Janet Hadley, a new Branch member, has agreed to run with this portfolio. This is heaven-sent, since she is a newly retired teacher from the Lycée International de Saint-Germain-en-Laye, and she knows from experience how the demand for this outreach exists and she has already identified a number of ways in which we can respond. This is an exciting project and we are grateful to Janet for taking this on.

We are sad to announce the recent deaths of two Branch members who survived their experiences in the Second World War:

Charles Hargrove OBE, who served in the British Army as a liaison officer during the Normandy Landings. He has been buried in the Asnelle the town where he landed in 1944, and where he and his wife Françoise subsequently lived for many years; and

Jean-Pierre Renouard who was captured by the Germans while aiding his father in the Résistance in the Bordeaux area. Jean-Pierre at the age of 16 was imprisoned at Bergen-Belsen. He wrote his story in Grahame Warby's book.

We send our sincere condoleances to their families.

"We will remember them"

FOR YOUR DIARY

Date	**Event**	**Venue**
16th October	Branch Committee Meeting	Clubhouse
28th October	Poppy Coffee Morning	Ambassador's Residence
11th November	Commonwealth Service of Remembrance	Notre Dame Cathedral
11thNovember	Cenotaph Service*	Whitehall, London
*Anyone wishing take part in the march-past contact Janet Warby soonest		
2nd half November	Paris Joint Services Dinner (RNVRA, RBL, RAFA)*	
20th November	Branch Committee Meeting	Clubhouse
24th November	Branch AGM	Clubhouse
15th December	Christmas Lunch	Clubhouse



POPPY APPEAL COFFEE MORNING 2014

LADY RICKETTS, wife of H.M. Ambassador to France

Has kindly accepted to host a Coffee Morning

In aid of the Poppy Appeal

Which the ROYAL BRITISH LEGION, PARIS BRANCH

Organizes every year for the benefit of the

EARL HAIG BENEVOLENT FUND

The Coffee Morning will take place at

THE BRITISH AMBASSADOR'S RESIDENCE

39 rue du Faubourg St. Honoré,

Paris 8eme

TUESDAY, 28th OCTOBER, 2014

10h30 - 12h00

Please send your stamped addressed envelope to :

Miss Joan Hicks,
6 rue des Petits Prés,
78810 FEUCHEROLLES
01 30 54 33 06/06 19 17 34 48
PLEASE PRINT YOUR NAMES IN CAPITAL LETTERS

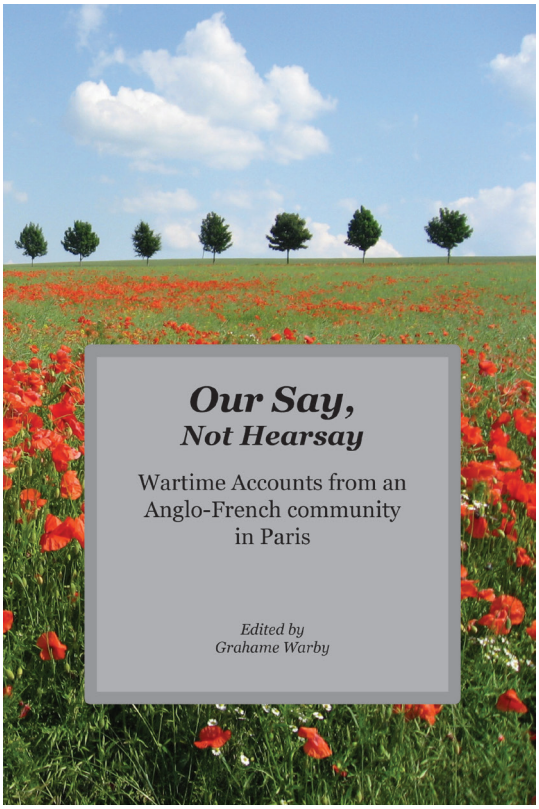
An invitation card for presentation at the entrance will be sent to you. This is a Charity event, please give generously. All donations welcome. I.D. Cards or Passports required. Numbers are limited. Date limit for applications 24/10/2014

MansionFIELD
a division of Zeticula Ltd, The Roan, Kilkerran, KA19 8LS, Scotland

is delighted to announce the publication of

Our Say, Not Hearsay
Wartime Accounts from an Anglo-French community in Paris

Edited by
Grahame Warby



Members and friends of an Anglo-French community in Paris share their first-hand experiences of war and conflict, predominantly during World War II in France and in Britain, but also in more recent conflicts. Some of the accounts are movingly short, others longer and more assured; some 'made the headlines', while others have never been recounted before. All the contributors – as children, civilians, or servicemen and women - tell fascinating and important stories, and the collection is illustrated throughout with personal and family photographs, documents and sketches. In the words of the Editor, "I bid you to read on."

"The glory, respect and recognition for this book lands squarely on those players which have so kindly and with utmost dedication, to fact and timing, shared what are very personal accounts. ... This book is as much a collection of stories from a community who have lived through a shared set of experiences as compared to the mutual affiliation they share of a notable charitable organisation. ... The players who have contributed to this book have done so with magnificent support for its aims. This is not a tome for profit; any sales proceeds will be donated to the Royal British Legion (Paris Branch)."

From the Introduction by Graham Warby

Paperback £15.95 €20 290 pages *ISBN 978 1 905021 14 7*

Published 28 October 2014

le 20 septembre à
BENNECOURT

LE CENTENAIRE DE 1914

9H30 :
Arrivée du rallye
Défilé de la GARDE

10h30 :
Cérémonie
au Jardin LECLERC

11h45 :
Inauguration
de l'exposition du centenaire
(Médiathèque)



Le rallye du centenaire
(1914 - 2014)

Trois cents Britanniques font le voyage de LONDRES à BENNECOURT



Le célèbre régiment des Coldstream Guards

Le 2e Régiment d'Infanterie de La Garde républicaine

Des figurants en costume d'époque
- les jeunes sapeurs pompiers
- les cavaliers de Bennecourt

Les autorités militaires et civiles du Royaume-Uni, de France, de Belgique

De nombreux drapeaux patriotiques les A.C, les comité de jumelage, les bénévoles, les associations

COMMEMORATION DU CENTENAIRE
(1914 – 2014)

DE 9H00 A 16H00
ARRIVEE DU RALLYE CYCLISTE EN PROVENANCE DE LONDRES
COMMEMORATION DU CENTENAIRE
INAUGURATION DE L'EXPOSITION





PROGRAMME DU 20 SEPTEMBRE animé par le GRAND ORCHESTRE des COLDSTREAM GUARDS

9h00 : Arrivée du rallye « BIKE TO BENNECOURT », rue des Coudrayes, Tripleval)
Formation du défilé avec les figurants et les chevaux.

9h00 : Accueil des personnalités civiles et militaires en mairie.

10h00 : Accueil du défilé par le Préfet des Yvelines et l'Attaché de défense du Royaume-Uni devant la mairie en présence des autorités, des drapeaux, de La Garde républicaine, des officiers supérieurs.

10h30 : Mise en place du cortège, départ pour le jardin J.F Leclerc, mort pour la France en septembre 1914.

10h45 : Cérémonie du Souvenir Franco- Britannique au monument (rue de l'Eglise).

12h00 : Inauguration de l'exposition du Centenaire à la médiathèque.

15h00 : Messe à l'église Saint Ouen de Bennecourt par Monseigneur Aumônier, Evêque de Versailles. L'église était dédiée aux réfugiés Belges pendant la guerre et conserve des vitraux dédiés à l'histoire de ce pays.

SPONSORS

Yvelines Conseil général

La Grande Guerre

BENNECOURT

EXPOSITION

CENTENAIRE 14 1918

DU 20 SEPTEMBRE AU 11 OCTOBRE 2014

BENNECOURT



Médiathèque Emile Zola

Tél. : 01 30 93 28 64

Rue de l'Eglise - 78270 Bennecourt

■ Mardi : 15h/19h ■ Mercredi : 14h30/18h ■ Jeudi : 15h/18h
■ Vendredi : 15h/17h30 ■ Samedi : 9h/12h - 14h/17h
Ouverture exceptionnelle : dimanche 21/09 de 14h30/18h

Yvelines Conseil général

mlm Musée des Lettres et Manuscrits

BENNECOURT

CENTENAIRE 14 1918

Samedi 20 septembre 2014
15h30 : Dédicace de Jean- Louis Beaucarnot pour son livre « Nos familles dans la grande guerre » aux Editions J.C. Lattès.

Dimanche 21 septembre 2014
14h30 à 18h00 : ouverture exceptionnelle de la médiathèque
14h30 à 17h30 : Ouverture exceptionnelle de l'exposition et de l'église : les vitraux
15h00 : Association « Bennecourt à cheval »: représentation équestre en costumes d'époque
15h30 : Conférence Jacques Ganty sur « La guerre 1914-1918, le chassé-croisé belge », suivi de la dédicace de son livre « La guerre 1914-1918 dans l'entité de Walcourt. Un fameux chassé-croisé franco-belge »
16h30 : « Correspondances et Lettres de poilus » par la compagnie de théâtre BVL de Magny en Vexin

PROGRAMME DES ANIMATIONS ET CONFERENCES DANS LE CADRE DE L'EXPOSITION
"LA GRANDE GUERRE" A LA MEDIATHEQUE EMILE ZOLA DE BENNECOURT

Mercredi 24 septembre 2014
15h00 : Atelier de fabrication de Nénette d'objets porte-bonheur et jouets pour les enfants à partir de 8 ans (places limitées, s'inscrire à la médiathèque à partir du 16 sept. 2014

Vendredi 26 septembre 2014
20h30 : Projection des films « Les derniers de la der des ders », « Le dernier survivant »
La projection sera suivie d'un débat avec le réalisateur des films, Jean-Marc Surcin, réalisateur chez France2.

Samedi 27 septembre 2014
15h00 : Projection des films « Adieu 14 »,
La projection sera suivie d'un débat avec le réalisateur Jean-Marc Surcin,

Mercredi 1er octobre
15h00 : Atelier de fabrication de Nénette d'objets porte-bonheur et jouets pour les enfants à partir de 8 ans (places limitées, s'inscrire à la médiathèque à partir du 16 sept. 2014

Vendredi 3 octobre 2014
20h30 : Conférence sur « Les origines du conflit » par M. Philippe Conrad.

Samedi 4 octobre 2014
15h30 : Lecture de lettres de poilus par Sylvie Vannucchi de l'association de théâtre de Bennecourt (ATDB) **et 16h30**

Samedi 11 octobre 2014
15h00 : Débat avec M. Gérard Dubois autour de ses recherches « Un canton, quatre destins ».
Ce document est réalisé grâce à ses recherches sur le destin de quatre individus (1 de Jeufosse, 1 de La Villeneuve en Chevrie, 1 de Port Villez, 1 de Bennecourt) qui ont participé à différentes batailles pendant la Grande Guerre et dont le destin s'est croisé à un moment de l'Histoire.
16h30 : « Correspondances et Lettres de poilus » par la compagnie de théâtre BVL de Magny en Vexin

LETTER FROM JOAN HICKS
Our Events Organizer

Dear Friends,

The Summer Holidays are behind us and it is back to our duties and to the pleasure of meeting you all at our RBL events and especially our monthly Club Lunches.

We are very grateful for Tony our Chef who works hard to offer us a variety of dishes. To make the planning and purchasing task easier for him can I take this opportunity to spell out some guidelines for us all to follow:

- Tony must know in good time how many members and guests to cater for. Your reservations must be made no later than 5 days before the lunch date.
- Payment at the time of the reservation should be made by cheque, made out to "RBL" and posted to me.
- If you have to cancel in the period up to 2 days before the lunch, then you will be reimbursed.
- Tony and I should not be covering late cancellations of unpaid reservations, which has been happening recently.
- Tony and I will be delighted to cater for a minimum of 15 couverts and a maximum of 25.

These lunches are a marvelous way to meet with our friends, of exchanging our ideas, and for some us the opportunity to talk about our war-time experiences. Not least they can spark off ideas for new RBL projects, and also attract new members.

I look forward to meeting you at our lunches and at other events. We shall shortly be releasing our Lunch dates for you to put in your diary.

Yours,

Joan

30th September 2014

Dear all,

Subscriptions 2014-15

Firstly I should thank those exceptionally conscientious members who have anticipated the date and already sent in their subscriptions and donations to the Poppy Appeal for the coming year.

For those of you who, like me, need a reminder when it comes to reaching for my cheque book, I am once again writing to ask you to send in your annual subscription to the Royal British Legion Paris Branch. It is due on 1st October.

As Roger will undoubtedly be saying elsewhere in this letter,It has been an exceptionally busy year with numerous anniversary events , some of which you may have seen photos of on our website – The current one you can see there is the splendid annual event run by Didier Dumont as mayor of his village Bennecourt.

Next year too will be a busy one and we shall be holding, and be involved in, many more events, especially at our HQ which is used more and more frequently.

Notably we have a very popular lunch every month there and I would encourage those of you within range to take the opportunity to join us and to join in the chat about what is going on.

If you can't come to a lunch but want to know what else is on, or you need to check a date, don't forget to use our website rblfrance.org.
Any suggestions as to what you would like to see on it, by the way, will be gratefully received.

To return to our muttons, as we say in English: Please send in your cheque for your subscription for 2014/15 with the form on the following page. If you get this letter by e-mail you can print out the page. If your printer has broken down at the critical moment (as usual?), just write the cheque and send it with your name. We'll do the rest.

Best regards

Mark Yates

Membership secretary

Bonjour à tous,

Cotisations 2014-15

Tout d'abord j'aimerais remercier les quelques adhérents très consciencieux qui ont anticipé la date et qui ont déjà envoyé leurs cotisations et des dons au Poppy Appeal pour l'année à venir.

Pour ceux d'entre vous qui, comme moi, ont besoin d'un rappel à l'ordre avant de sortir leurs carnets de chèques, je vous annonce que la date fatidique de renouvellement de votre adhésion à la Royal British Legion tombe le 1er Octobre.

Comme Roger détaille ailleurs dans cette Newsletter, nous sortons d'une année particulièrement chargée, avec de nombreux évènements, commémorations et manifestations dont certains sont illustrés par des photos sur notre site Web – Actuellement il y figure des photos du remarquable évènement que monte notre membre Didier Dumont chaque année en tant que maire de son village de Bennecourt.

Le programme pour l'année prochaine s'annonce aussi serré, et le 'Paris branch' est appelé à participer dans un nombre croissant d'événements. Notre QG, rue des Acacias, est utilisé de plus en plus fréquemment. Notamment, nos déjeuners mensuels s'avèrent très populaires et je n'hésite pas à vous inciter à vous joindre à nous pour participer en un moment toujours agréable.

Pour des informations sur les dates de ces déjeuners, ou pour d'autres informations, n'oubliez pas que notre site Web rblfrance.org reste toujours disponible. D'ailleurs des suggestions quant à la structure et le contenu du site seront toujours les bienvenues.

Pour en revenir à l'essentiel : Sur la page suivante vous trouverez des détails de votre cotisation pour l'année 2014/15. Renvoyez-la, s'il vous plaît avec votre cheque. Si vous recevez ceci par e-mail imprimez la page. Pour le cas où vous ne pouvez l'imprimer, il suffit d'écrire votre chèque et l'envoyer avec votre nom. Nous saurions faire le nécessaire.

Je vous remercie d'avance,

Bien cordialement

Mark Yates

Membership secretary

The Royal British Legion Paris Branch

Poppy Appeal & Subscriptions 2014-15 (payable 1° Oct 2014)

Poppy Appeal et Cotisations 2014-15 (dues 1° oct 2014)

- Normal / *Normale* 46 Euros
- Reduced / *Réduite* (65 and + / *65 ans et* +) 37 Euros
- 25 years and under / *25 ans ou moins* 21 Euros

Poppy Appeal contribution
Don au "Poppy Appeal" .....

Annual subscription
Cotisation annuelle .....

Administrative Fund donation
Don aux fonds administratifs .....

TOTAL .....

Name / Nom .....

Address / Adresse .....

.....

e-mail ……..……...

Please underline if new or changed – veuillez souligner s'il est nouveau ou si vous l'avez modifié.

Please tick the box below if you require a fiscal receipt and, if so, enclose a stamped addressed envelope.

Veuillez cocher la case si vous désirer un récépissé fiscal et, dans ce cas, joindre une enveloppe timbrée à votre attention.

☐

Please make your cheque payable to the "Royal British Legion".
Veuillez établir votre cheque à l'ordre de "Royal British Legion"

Royal British Legion. 28 rue des Acacias 75017 PARIS . Tel 01 47 42 19 26
Website : http://www.rblfrance.org/ e-mail : mfyates@gmail.com